

Rebellion + Desertion = Curses

Part 2 — Possible modern diseases, disorders, and cancers matching the Hebrew descriptions

Deuteronomy 28:15–68 affliction terms

Companion to Part 1 (Hebrew → English disease map). This document suggests *plausible* modern medical correlates for each Hebrew term. Ancient writers did not use modern taxonomy; one Hebrew word often covered several conditions.

Method: Strong's / lexicon glosses + biblical context + ancient Near Eastern medicine + modern clinical parallels. Listed items are **possibilities**, not confirmed ancient diagnoses.

Not medical advice. “Cancer” appears only where wasting, masses, or chronic non-healing lesions reasonably match the Hebrew description.

Affliction-by-affliction correlates

דֶּבֶר H1698 **dever** — pestilence / plague

Deuteronomy 28:21

Infectious epidemics (most likely)

- Bubonic plague (*Yersinia pestis*)
- Cholera
- Typhoid or typhus
- Smallpox (epidemic form)
- Influenza pandemics
- Measles (epidemic)
- Dysentery / shigellosis (epidemic dysentery)
- Any high-mortality epidemic where disease “cleaves” to a population

Hebrew emphasizes divinely sent *epidemic* judgment, not a single pathogen. Livestock pestilence (Exodus 9:3) parallels anthrax or rinderpest in other texts.

שִׁחַפֶּת H7829 *shachepheth* — consumption / wasting disease

Deuteronomy 28:22

Wasting illnesses

- **Tuberculosis** (pulmonary and extrapulmonary) — strongest single correlate; modern Hebrew *shachefet* still means TB
- Advanced **cancer cachexia** (lung, stomach, pancreatic, lymphoma, etc.)
- HIV/AIDS wasting syndrome
- Severe chronic heart failure (cardiac cachexia)
- End-stage COPD / emphysema with weight loss
- Chronic parasitic load (hookworm, schistosomiasis) with malnutrition
- Severe malnutrition / marasmus

Ancient authors could not distinguish TB from other wasting diseases. The term is a *syndrome* (progressive emaciation, weakness, often with fever) rather than one modern ICD code.

קִדְדָּחַת H6920 *qaddachath* — fever / burning ague

Deuteronomy 28:22

- Malaria (endemic in Egypt and Canaan regions)
- Typhoid / paratyphoid fever
- Influenza
- Sepsis / bacteremia
- Brucellosis
- Leptospirosis
- Any sustained febrile illness paired with wasting in v. 22

דלקת H1816 **dalleqeth** — inflammation / inflammatory disease

Deuteronomy 28:22

- Cellulitis and erysipelas
- Sepsis with systemic inflammation
- Rheumatic fever
- Severe respiratory infection (pneumonia)
- Inflammatory bowel disease (severe flare)
- Autoimmune vasculitis
- Osteomyelitis

Root idea: burning inflammation (*deleq* = burn). Fits hot, red, swollen infectious or autoimmune processes.

חֲרָחֹר H2746 **charchur** — extreme burning / fiery heat

Deuteronomy 28:22

- Hyperpyrexia (very high fever)
- Heat stroke / heat exhaustion (desert climate)
- Severe dehydration with elevated body temperature
- Burning dysuria from urinary tract infection
- Intense inflammatory skin eruption with burning pain

Some translations render as drought rather than bodily disease; in Deuteronomy 28:22 it sits among bodily afflictions, so fever/heat syndromes fit best.

שֶׁחִין מִצְרַיִם H7822 **shchin Mitzrayim** — boil(s) of Egypt

Deuteronomy 28:27 (Egypt named in this chapter)

- Furuncles and carbuncles (*Staphylococcus aureus*)
- Cutaneous anthrax (painful black eschar with swelling)
- Smallpox pustules (if historical smallpox present)
- Impetigo / ecthyma (deeper pustular infection)
- Plague buboes (if linked to epidemic context)
- Cutaneous leishmaniasis (chronic ulcers)
- Chronic non-healing skin ulcers (could include **skin cancer** — SCC, BCC — in modern terms, though ancients would not classify as cancer)

Recalls Exodus 9:9–11 (festering boils on humans and animals). Incurable in v. 27 = chronic, treatment-resistant skin disease.

עֲפָלִים H6076 **ophalim** — tumors / swellings / emerods

Deuteronomy 28:27

- Hemorrhoids (internal / external)
- Anal or perianal abscess / fistula
- Inguinal or axillary **lymph node enlargement** (infection or lymphoma)
- Plague buboes (swollen lymph nodes)
- Rectal prolapse with swelling
- **Colorectal cancer** or anal cancer (mass / obstruction)
- Pelvic tumors (uterine, ovarian in women)
- Prostate enlargement or **prostate cancer** (if generalized to groin swelling)

Same root used for Philistine “tumors” in 1 Samuel 5–6 (with rats / dysentery context).

טְחֹרִים H2914 *techorim* — hemorrhoids / anal tumors

Deuteronomy 28:27 (Qere; paired with ophalim)

- Hemorrhoids (grades I–IV)
- Thrombosed external hemorrhoid
- Anal fissure with swelling
- Perianal hematoma
- Rectal prolapse
- Dysentery-related rectal inflammation (Shigella, amoebic colitis)
- **Anal cancer** or rectal adenocarcinoma (chronic mass / bleeding)

Often merged with *ophalim* in English Bibles. Medical texts link to dysentery complications in ancient armies and sieges.

גָּרַב H1618 *garav* — scab / scaly eruption

Deuteronomy 28:27; Leviticus 21:20; 22:22

- Eczema / atopic dermatitis
- Psoriasis
- Tinea corporis / capitis (ringworm)
- Impetigo (crusted scabs)
- Scabies (with secondary crusting)
- Seborrheic dermatitis
- Pityriasis rosea

Not modern nutritional scurvy (vitamin C deficiency) — KJV “scurvy” for *garav* is a misleading traditional rendering. Hebrew = itchy, scaly, scratchable skin.

חֶרֶס H2775 **cheres** — itch / dry eruption

Deuteronomy 28:27

- Scabies (intense nocturnal itch)
- Chronic eczema
- Contact dermatitis
- Prurigo nodularis
- Xerosis (severe dry skin) in arid climate
- Cutaneous leishmaniasis (dry, crusted lesions)
- Body lice infestation (with excoriation)

Paired with *garav* as overlapping dermatology: scale + itch. Distinct from *tsara'ath* (Leviticus 13) but same general domain.

שָׁחִין רֶעַ H7822 **shchin ra** — severe boil(s), head to foot

Deuteronomy 28:35

- Disseminated furunculosis / carbunculosis
- Generalized impetigo or ecthyma
- Erythroderma (exfoliative skin failure)
- Severe bullous disease (pemphigus, bullous pemphigoid)
- Disseminated cutaneous infection in immunocompromised state
- Metastatic **skin involvement** from internal malignancy (rare modern correlate)

Same root as Egyptian boils but emphasized as total-body, incurable severity (sole of foot to crown).

שִׁגְעוֹן H7697 **shigaon — madness**

Deuteronomy 28:28

Psychiatric / neurological

- Schizophrenia or schizophreniform disorder
- Bipolar I disorder (manic episode with psychosis)
- Brief psychotic disorder
- Delirium (infectious, metabolic, post-siege)
- Severe PTSD with dissociation
- Neurosyphilis (general paresis) — if historical presence assumed

עִוְרוֹן H5788 **'ivvaron — blindness**

Deuteronomy 28:28

- Cataracts
- Glaucoma
- Trachoma (leading ancient cause of blindness in Near East)
- Onchocerciasis (river blindness)
- Corneal scarring from infection or trauma
- Optic neuritis / optic atrophy
- Vitamin A deficiency (xerophthalmia)
- Diabetic retinopathy (modern parallel to “failing eyes”)

תִּמְהוֹן לֵבָב H8541 **timmahon levav — confusion / bewilderment of heart**

Deuteronomy 28:28

- Delirium
- Dementia (Alzheimer's, vascular dementia)
- Severe anxiety with cognitive impairment
- Post-traumatic stress with concentration failure
- Metabolic encephalopathy (dehydration, infection in siege)

מִשְׁגָּע H7696 meshuggah — driven mad / maddened

Deuteronomy 28:34

- Acute stress disorder
- PTSD (combat / siege / atrocity witness)
- Grief reaction with transient psychosis
- Adjustment disorder with mixed disturbance of emotion and conduct

Triggered by “the sight of what your eyes see” — trauma-induced mental break rather than chronic psychosis alone.

מַכּוֹת ... חֲלָיִים רָעִים H4347, H2483 — great plagues and sore sicknesses

Deuteronomy 28:59

- Any severe, prolonged epidemic or chronic disease not otherwise specified
- Multi-organ failure syndromes
- Hereditary degenerative conditions (prolonged)
- Recurrent malaria, TB, or dysentery over generations

Category language, not a single diagnosis.

כָּל־מִדּוֹה מִצְרַיִם H4064 **madveh Mitzrayim — all diseases of Egypt**

Deuteronomy 28:60 (Egypt named in this chapter)

Plausible Egypt-endemic or Egypt-associated conditions (collective)

- Schistosomiasis (bilharzia)
- Malaria
- Guinea worm (dracunculiasis)
- Trachoma and eye infections
- Parasitic intestinal diseases (roundworm, hookworm, tapeworm)
- Skin diseases from Nile-region climate (fungal, bacterial)
- Boils / anthrax / glanders (from Exodus plague context)
- Pestilence among livestock and humans
- Any condition Israel “dreaded” from Egyptian experience (v. 60)

Chapter does not itemize Exodus plagues here — only the collective “diseases of Egypt.” Do not read in frogs, lice, darkness, etc. unless another verse names them.

כָּל־חֵלִי ... כָּל־מַכָּה H2483, H4347 — **every sickness and every plague**

Deuteronomy 28:61

- Open-ended: any infectious, chronic, genetic, or malignant disease known or unknown to the author
- Includes modern categories absent from the ancient world: autoimmune disease, many cancers, genetic syndromes, novel viruses

לֵב רָגַז H7264 **lev ragaz — trembling heart**

Deuteronomy 28:65

- Generalized anxiety disorder
- Panic disorder
- PTSD (hypervigilance, startle)
- Palpitations from arrhythmia (atrial fibrillation, SVT)
- Hyperthyroidism
- Pheochromocytoma (rare ; episodic terror + tachycardia)

כָּלִיּוֹן עֵינַיִם H3631 **killayon einayim** — failing / wasting of the eyes

Deuteronomy 28:65

- Cataracts
- Age-related macular degeneration
- Glaucoma (progressive vision loss)
- Trachoma complications
- Chronic eye strain / exhaustion from grief (functional visual decline)
- Optic nerve atrophy

דָּאָבוֹן נֶפֶשׁ H1671 **da'avon nefesh** — despair / languishing of soul

Deuteronomy 28:65

- Major depressive disorder
- Persistent depressive disorder (dysthymia)
- Complicated grief / prolonged grief disorder
- Adjustment disorder with depressed mood
- Existential despair in exile (culturally framed as “soul” wasting)

Psychological / affective, not a cancer or infectious disease.

Summary table

Hebrew	Strong's	Primary modern domains	Cancers (where plausible)
dever	H1698	Epidemics	—
shachepheth	H7829	Wasting, TB, cachexia	Advanced cancer cachexia
qaddachath	H6920	Fevers	—
dalleqeth	H1816	Inflammation, infection	—
charchur	H2746	Hyperthermia, burning fever	—
shchin	H7822	Boils, ulcers, pustules	Skin cancer (chronic ulcer)
ophalim / techorim	H6076 / H2914	Hemorrhoids, abscess, buboes	Colorectal, anal, lymphoma
garav / cheres	H1618 / H2775	Dermatitis, scabies, tinea	—

Hebrew	Strong's	Primary modern domains	Cancers (where plausible)
shigaon / meshuggah	H7697 / H7696	Psychosis, PTSD, delirium	—
‘ivvaron / killayon	H5788 / H3631	Blindness, eye failure	— (ocular tumors rare fit)
timmahon / da’avon	H8541 / H1671	Dementia, depression	—
madveh Mitzrayim	H4064	Egypt-endemic parasites, eye, skin	—

Rebellion + Desertion = Curses (Part 2) — Companion to Part 1. Hebrew from Deuteronomy 28:15–68. Medical correlates are interpretive, not diagnostic of ancient intent.